

Malaria

Test before you treat. A rapid test lets you confirm malaria in the village and give the right treatment.

For health workers

Key messages

- Test every person with fever using a rapid diagnostic test where available.
- Treat positive cases following the current national guideline, and check the full course is taken.
- Refer severe cases, and refer sick young children and pregnant women early.
- Promote bed net use, and teach families to clear places where mosquitoes breed.
- Record tests, treatments and referrals in your register.

Refer immediately if the patient has

- Fits, confusion or unusual sleepiness
- Cannot drink or keeps vomiting
- Very pale or yellow
- Fast or difficult breathing
- Fever in a pregnant woman or a baby

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.